

Food Tests

Benedicts test for reducing sugars

Benedicts Test for Reducing Sugars

Procedure for liquid:

1. add an equal volume of Benedicts solution to the sample in a test tube
2. Shake thoroughly
3. Place the test tube in a beaker of boiling water for 2-3 minutes

Procedure for solid:

1. add finely chopped sample into a test tube containing 2cm³ of denoised water
2. Shake thoroughly
3. Allow solids to settle
4. decant the liquid into another test tube
5. Add equal volume of benedicts solution into the test tube
6. Shake thoroughly
7. Place test tube in a beaker of boiling water for 2-3 minutes

Positive result:

benedicts solution turns from blue to green/orange/yellow/red precipitate upon heating

Negative result:

Benedicts solution remains blue upon heating

Solution remained blue	No reducing sugars
Solution turned from blue to green precipitate	traces of reducing sugars
solution turned from blue to yellow/orange precipitate	moderate amount of reducing sugars
solution turns from blue to red precipitate	large amounts of reducing sugars

Reducing Sugars	Non-Reducing Sugars
- glucose - fructose - Maltose - Lactose - Glyceraldehyde - Arabinose	- Stachyose - Sucrose - Tehalose - Verbascose - Raffinose

Test for Starch

Add a few drops of iodine solution to sample on a white tile

positive result

iodine solution turns from yellow/brown/yellowish-brown to blue black

negative result

iodine solution remains yellow/brown/yellowish-brown

Alcohol Emulsion Test for Fats

Alcohol Emulsion Test for Fats

Procedure for Liquid

1. add 2cm³ of ethanol to a drop of the sample
2. Shake thoroughly
3. Add the solution to 2cm³ of water in a test tube

Procedure for Solid

1. add finely chopped sample into a test tube containing 2cm³ of ethanol
2. shake thoroughly
3. Allow solid to settle
4. Decant the liquid into another test tube containing 2cm³ of water.

Positive Result:

A cloudy white emulsion is formed (remember to state the change)

Negative Result:

Solution remains clear

Biurets Test for Proteins

Biurets Test for Proteins

Procedure for Liquid:

1. add an equal volume of sodium hydroxide to the sample in a test tube
2. add a drop of Copper(II)sulfate solution - shake after each drop

OR

1. add an equal volume of biurets solution to sample in a test tube
2. shake well and allow mixture to stand for 5 minutes

Procedure for Solid

1. Add finely chopped sample into a test tube containing 2cm³ of deionised water
2. shake thoroughly
3. Allow solids to settle
4. Decant the liquid into another test tube

Biurets Test for Proteins

5. Add an equal volume of sodium hydroxide to sample in the test tube
6. add a drop of Copper(II)sulfate solution - shake after each drop

Positive Result:

Solution turns from blue to violet

Negative result:

Solution remains blue
